

K-2 (Ages 5-7)

Grades K-2 · Ages 5-7

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

STUDENT COPY

1

hackles up!



Hackle

whose quills stand up when something feels off

2



Latch

LOCK IT

3



Peeper

SPOT IT

4



Pip

SHARE SMART

5



Buddy

SAFE PEOPLE

6



Ember

KIND AND WELL

7



Fixit

FIX IT

PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org

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OCTOBER 2026



Chapter

1

My Hackles Activity Book

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Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell

Grades K-2 (ages 5-7)

Field note

No. 1

For the illustrator and the teacher. This book is picture-first. Children are not expected to read. The teacher reads each instruction aloud (see the Teacher Guide). Every page has a small icon strip at the top: a speaker icon (teacher reads this), a crayon icon (color), a pencil icon (draw), a circle icon (circle), and a line icon (match). Words on pages are 1 to 3 words only, in large rounded type. Text in *[Illustration: ...]* brackets describes art for the illustrator and does not print. Style: warm, bright, simple, rounded shapes, diverse children, no scary imagery anywhere. Characters: Maya (6, wheelchair, curly hair, two dads), Omar (7, round glasses, puzzle cube), Lily (5, purple hearing aids, loves music), Dev (6, quiet, sketchbook), and Hackle (mascot, they/them: a baby hedgehog with soft pale-yellow, tangerine-tipped quills that stand up when something is off, and big kind eyes; not a dog). *[Illustration: character lineup spread for the inside cover.]* All scenarios are pretend. Never use real children's names, faces, or details. Never ask children to write real passwords, addresses, or personal information.



COVER

Picture 1



ART TO COME

Full-page cover. The four friends and Hackle stand together on a hill under a big sun, each holding a giant padlock-shaped balloon. Hackle's tangerine spikes are standing up, and Hackle wears a tiny cape. A banner reads "TRUST YOUR HACKLES." Four small icons at the bottom: a hand brushing up the back of the neck (Hackles Up), a flat palm (Pause), eyes (Check), a hand reaching out (Tell).

Chapter HACKLES

2

2

My Hackles Activity Book

My name: _____

My class: _____

Picture 2

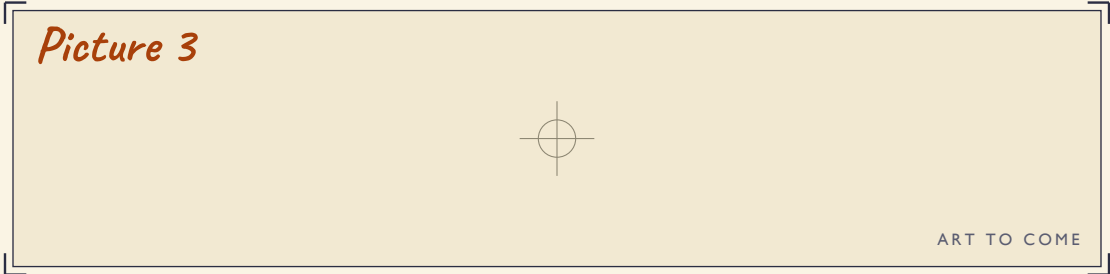


ART TO COME

A blank frame labeled "Draw yourself!" with crayons around it.

2

MEET THE FRIENDS



Five character boxes in a row. Under each, one word.

MAYA	OMAR	LILY	DEV	HACKLE
[Illustration: Maya in her bright blue wheelchair, waving]	[Illustration: Omar with glasses holding a puzzle cube]	[Illustration: Lily dancing, purple hearing aids]	[Illustration: Dev holding a sketchbook]	[Illustration: Hackle, a baby hedgehog with pale-yellow, tangerine-tipped quills standing up, waving]
"Why?"	"Pattern!"	"Breathe."	"Oops!"	"Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell."

Color the friends! (crayon icon)

Hackles are the tingly uh-oh feeling. When your hackles go up, you can do four things. A false alarm is okay! And it is never your fault.

HACKLES UP?	PAUSE	CHECK	TELL
[Illustration: a hand brushing up the back of the neck, little spikes popping up]	[Illustration: a flat hand like a stop sign]	[Illustration: two fingers pointing at eyes]	[Illustration: hand on heart, then reaching out]
Tingly?	Stop. Take a breath.	Look. Is a helper near?	Tell a helper.

Trace each hand and say the word out loud!

LESSON 1: MY TELL-SOMEONE TEAM

Page 1: My Helper Hand (pencil icon)

2

Picture 4



ART TO COME

A large outline of a hand with five fingers, each fingertip a big circle. Beside it, a little Hackle pointing at the hand.

- Trace your hand here. Or use this one.
- On three fingers, draw a helper who can listen, help, and keep you safe.
- Fingers 4 and 5: more helpers if you have them!

Helpers at school (circle icon): Circle the helpers who can help you.

Picture 5



ART TO COME

Six round pictures in a row: a teacher at a whiteboard, a school nurse with a first-aid bag, a school counselor with a heart sticker, a principal, a bus driver, a lunch helper. Each with a one-word label: Teacher, Nurse, Counselor, Principal, Bus, Lunch.

Helpers at home (draw icon): Draw one helper at home.

2

Picture 6

ART TO COME

*A blank house-shaped frame labeled "Home helper."***Page 2: Say it out loud!***Picture 7*

ART TO COME

*A speech bubble reading "I NEED HELP." with a child reaching out a hand toward a smiling grown-up.*Say it with your partner: **"I need help."**Your partner says: **"Thank you for telling me."***Picture 8*

ART TO COME

*Two children facing each other, one with a speech bubble "I need help," the other with a heart bubble "Thank you!"***Keep telling until someone helps! (match icon)**

Picture 9



ART TO COME

A path with five stepping stones, each with a smaller picture of a helper (teacher, nurse, counselor, principal, family). A little Hackle walks along the stones and waves at each.

Color the path. Point to the next helper.

Check yourself: Circle the people who can be helpers. (circle icon)

Picture 10



ART TO COME

Four pictures: a teacher, a nurse, a bus driver, and a stuffed bear. Children circle the three grown-up helpers.

LESSON 2: SECRET PASSWORDS

Page 1: A password is a secret key!

Picture 11



ART TO COME

A treasure chest with a big lock, and a small golden key. Hackle sits on the chest, spikes up, and puts a finger to their lips.

Color the key gold. Color the chest.

Who can know my password? (circle icon) Circle the safe picture.

Picture 12



ART TO COME

Two pictures. Left: a child whispering to a friend at the playground. Right: a child showing the password to a smiling parent. A tiny lock sits above the right picture for the teacher's reference.

Page 2: Make a silly password! (Pretend!)

Picture 13

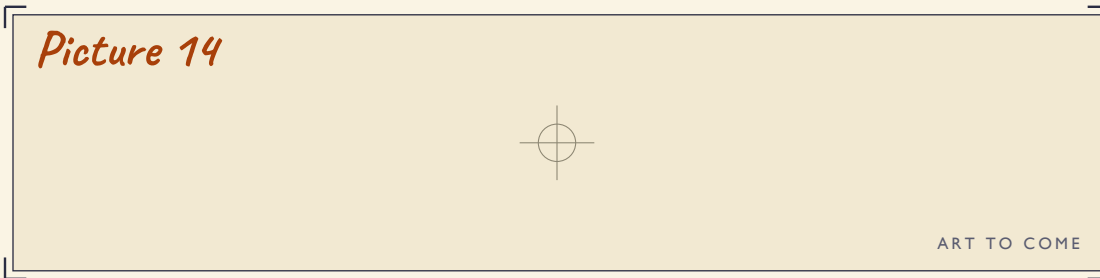


ART TO COME

Three empty boxes in a row, each with a small dotted outline, labeled "1, 2, 3." Under them: three little piles of picture cards labeled Color, Animal, Food.

1. Pick a color or feeling. Draw it in box 1.

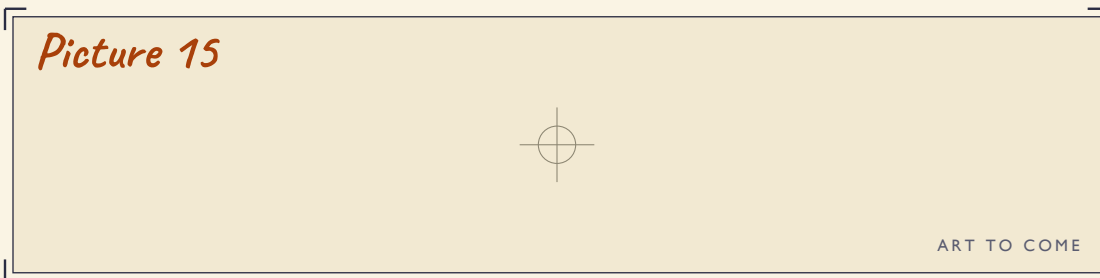
2. Pick an animal or thing. Draw it in box 2.
3. Pick a silly food. Draw it in box 3.



Example: box 1 shows a purple blob, box 2 shows a robot, box 3 shows a noodle.

This is a **pretend** password. Do not use it for real!

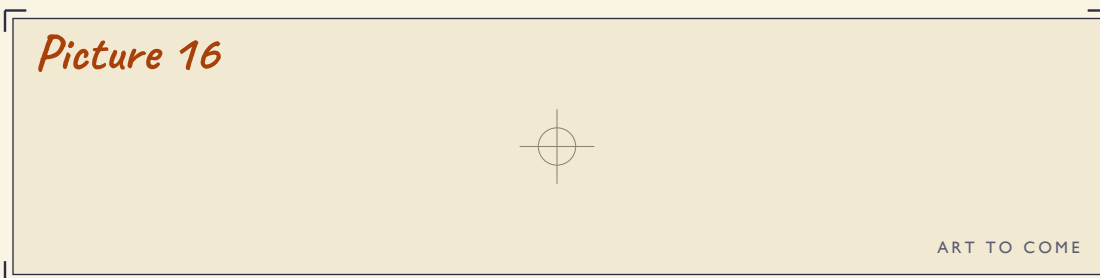
Page 3: Passwords are private!



Three scenes with a child holding up a Pause Palm: (1) a friend whispering "Tell me!", (2) a game-chat bubble saying "What's your password?", (3) a pretend official-looking message with a badge saying "I'm from the game! Tell me!". In each scene, the child has a speech bubble: "Private!"

Draw a **hand-stop sign** in each scene. (pencil icon)

Which are easy to guess? Which are silly-strong? (match icon)



Left column: a card with "1234," a card with "my name," a card with a silly picture (purple robot noodle). Right column: a sad face, a sad face, and a happy locked padlock. Children draw a line from each card to the right face.

LESSON 3: PAUSE AND ASK

Page 1: Pop-up!

Picture 17



ART TO COME

A big tablet screen with a flashing pop-up box in the middle. The box has stars, bright colors, and the words "FREE! YOU WON!" Maya, in her wheelchair, holds up a Pause Palm. Her dad sits next to her.

Draw a **Pause Palm** on the pop-up. (pencil icon)

Tricky words! Circle the tricky words. (circle icon)

Picture 18



ART TO COME

Three flashing labels: "FREE!", "WON!", "HURRY!" next to three calm labels: "Story," "Loading," "Level 2." Children circle the three tricky labels.

Page 2: Red or green?

Picture 19

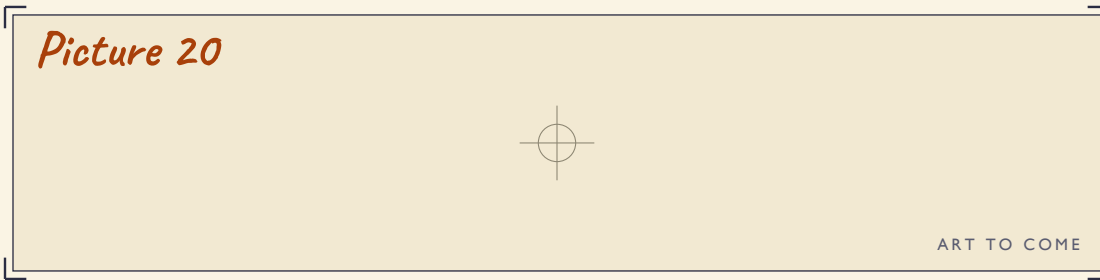


ART TO COME

Six small screens in a grid. Screens 1, 3, and 5 are flashing pop-ups ("FREE GEMS!", "YOUR TABLET IS BROKEN! TAP!", "YOU WON!"). Screens 2, 4, and 6 are calm ("Story time," "Loading," "Color game"). Each screen has a small circle below it for coloring.

Color the circle **red** if you Pause and ask. Color it **green** if it is calm. (A grown-up is still near!)

Page 3: Pause and ask!



A comic strip of four panels. Panel 1: Maya with a tablet. Panel 2: Pop-up appears. Panel 3: Maya holds up a Pause Palm. Panel 4: Maya shows her dad and they give each other a high-five.

Number the panels 1, 2, 3, 4. (pencil icon)

Say: "Can you check this?"

LESSON 4: THE OOPS BUTTON

Page 1: Press the Oops Button!

Picture 21



ART TO COME

A big red button in the center of the page labeled "OOPS!" with a heart on top. Dev stands next to it with a worried face. His grandmother stands nearby with open arms.

Color the button red. Color Dev's face. How does he feel? (circle icon)

Picture 22



ART TO COME

A row of three faces under the picture: worried, calm, happy. The child circles one for Dev before and after telling. Two circles: "Before" and "After."

Page 2: Oops. Tell. Fixed.

Picture 23



ART TO COME

Three panels in a row. Panel 1: Dev taps the tablet; a small gray cloud appears. Panel 2: Dev tells Grandma; he holds the Oops button; Grandma smiles. Panel 3: They turn the tablet off together; the cloud is gone; a heart appears.

Under each panel, trace the word: **OOPS. TELL. FIXED.** (pencil icon)

What does a helper say? Color the **heart bubble.** (crayon icon)

Picture 24

ART TO COME

Two speech bubbles. Left: a heart with "Thank you for telling me." Right: a gray bubble with a small frown. Only the left is correct. The frown bubble is drawn in plain gray, not scary.

Page 3: My body clues*Picture 25*

ART TO COME

A simple child outline with three arrows: tummy (swirl), face (flushed), heart (fast beat).

Color the places where your body might say "Pause!" (crayon icon)

My Oops Button card. (Cut out from the Reproducibles page.)

Color it red. Keep it in your pocket or folder.

LESSON 5: PRIVATE VS. PUBLIC

Page 1: Hackle's House

Picture 26



ART TO COME

A big picture of Hackle's house. A large front window with a sign that says "OKAY TO SHARE." A front door with a lock and a sign that says "PRIVATE." Hackle stands in front, smiling.

In the window, draw one thing that is okay to share. (pencil icon) Examples: a favorite color, a favorite animal.

Inside the house, draw one private thing. (pencil icon) Examples: a key, a lock.

(Do not draw your real address!)

Page 2: Sort it! (match icon)

Picture 27



ART TO COME

Two big boxes at the bottom: "Window" (open window icon) and "Inside" (closed door icon with a lock). Eight small pictures above: favorite color crayon, favorite animal (cat), a game controller (game I like), house with address number, school building, phone with number, key with "password" tag, a child's face photo with a question mark.

Draw a line from each picture to **Window** or **Inside**.

The tricky one! The face photo goes in the middle. Draw a **Pause Palm** next to it. (Ask a grown-up first.)

Page 3: Put a lock on it! (circle icon)

Picture 28



ART TO COME

Four pictures in a row: a crayon (favorite color), a house address sign, a school building, a dog doing a trick.

Draw a **lock** on the private ones.

LESSON 6: ONLINE FRIENDS VS. REAL FRIENDS

Page 1: Real friends and online friends

Picture 29



ART TO COME

Left half: Maya playing at recess with two classmates, labeled "Friends I see." Right half: a tablet with a game screen showing a cartoon avatar with a question mark above its head, labeled "Online players." Hackle stands in the middle holding a sign: "Not sure who? Pause!"

Color the **friends I see**. Draw a **question mark** on the online player.

Page 2: Surprise or Tell? (match icon)

Picture 30



ART TO COME

Two big boxes: "Happy Surprise" with a party hat and balloons, and "Tell a Grown-Up" with a heart-and-hand. Eight small pictures to match: (1) hidden birthday present for Dad, (2) a child holding a drawing behind their back for Mom, (3) a game chat bubble saying "Don't tell your parents," (4) a message saying "Let's talk somewhere else, just us," (5) a game chat asking "What school do you go to?", (6) a message saying "Send me a picture of you," (7) a surprise party with confetti, (8) a game chat with a gift and "Keep it secret."

Draw a line from each picture to the right box.

Page 3: Game chat: Pause!

Picture 31

ART TO COME

A pretend game-chat screen with an avatar named "Player123" and a bubble: "Free coins if you tell me where you live!" Below, Lily with a hearing aid holds up a Pause Palm and a speech bubble: "I'll tell my grown-up!"

Draw a **hand-stop sign** on the chat. Color the **heart-and-hand**.
(crayon icon)

It is never your fault. Trace the words. (pencil icon)

Picture 32

ART TO COME

A large heart with "Never my fault" in big dotted letters for tracing.

LESSON 7: KIND CLICKS

Page 1: Kind or unkind?

Picture 33



ART TO COME

A row of six chat bubbles. Three kind (heart, thumbs-up, smile) with messages in picture form, three unkind (a frown, a stop sign) as simple icons. Plain, mild; no harsh words.

Color the **kind** bubbles. Draw a **Pause Palm** on the unkind ones.
(crayon and pencil icons)

Page 2: What do I do?

Picture 34



ART TO COME

Dev looking at a tablet with a small gray frown bubble above it. Three arrow paths lead from Dev: one to "Write back mean" (a crossed-out arrow), one to "Show a grown-up" (Grandma with open arms, a green check), one to "Be a helper" (Lily patting Dev's shoulder, a green check).

Follow the **good paths** with your crayon. Cross out the path we do **not** choose. (match icon)

Page 3: My kind heart

Picture 35



ART TO COME

A big empty heart in the center, surrounded by little hearts and stars. At the bottom, a row of sentence-frame pictures: a smile icon "I like your _____", two hands icon "Want to play?", a clapping icon "Good try!"

Draw or write one **kind message** you could send a friend. (pencil icon)

Color the Kindness Bubble! Add hearts all around it. (crayon icon)

LESSON 8: REAL OR PRETEND?

Page 1: Real or pretend?

2

Picture 36



ART TO COME

Six pictures in a grid. Each has two circles below: a heart (Real) and a magic wand (Pretend). Pictures: a dog; a flying pig; an apple; a rainbow cat; a playground; a robot made of spaghetti.

Color the **heart** if it is real. Color the **wand** if it is pretend. (circle icon)

Page 2: The mystery voice

Picture 37



ART TO COME

A robot-shaped speech bubble with swirly lines, coming from a closed laptop shape (no face, no person). Omar and Maya listen. Omar holds up a Pause Palm. The bubble reads "Hello! Tell me your name!"

Draw a **Pause Palm** on Omar's hand. (pencil icon)

A computer can make voices and pictures that sound and look real.

When I am not sure, I: (match icon)

Picture 38

ART TO COME

Three boxes: "Ask a grown-up" (child and parent), "Look for clues" (magnifying glass), "Use our code word" (a lock with a star). A small Hackle in the middle. The child draws a line from the "?" in the center to each box.

Page 3: Our family code word*Picture 39*

ART TO COME

A friendly padlock with a star and a ribbon. A family (grown-up and child) whispering together, with a cloud over them that says "Code word (private!)."

Ask your family to pick a silly code word. **Do not write it here!**
Keep it in your head and heart. (The Reproducibles page has a card for your family to keep.)

LESSON 9: MY BODY IS MINE

Field note

No. 2

Teacher note for this page. Use only after teaching Lesson 9 with the Teacher Guide. These pages show no body detail and no harm. Children practice **No. Go. Tell.**

Page 1: My body is mine!

Picture 40



ART TO COME

A big rainbow bubble (a large circle) with a heart in the middle. Hackle sits beside it holding a small flag that reads "MINE." No child or body is drawn.

Color the bubble all the way around the heart. Color the heart your favorite color. (crayon icon) *Everything in the bubble belongs to the child.*

Page 2: No. Go. Tell. (pencil icon)

Picture 41



ART TO COME

Three big pictures in a row, with a dotted line connecting them. Picture 1: a child with a stop-sign hand, labeled "NO." Picture 2: the same child taking two steps away, labeled "GO." Picture 3: the child with hand on heart reaching toward a smiling grown-up, labeled "TELL."

Trace the dotted line from **No** to **Go** to **Tell**.

Page 3: My Helper Hand again

Picture 42

ART TO COME

A hand outline with three finger circles.

Draw your helpers on the fingers. Who could you tell? (pencil icon)

Keep telling until someone helps. (circle icon)

Picture 43

ART TO COME

A child holding up a hand with five fingers, each fingertip a small helper face. The first helper looks busy with a phone; the child moves to the second helper, who is smiling and kneeling to listen. The picture is calm and encouraging.

Circle the helper who **listens and helps**.

It is never your fault. Say it out loud. Color the heart. (crayon icon)

Picture 44

ART TO COME

A large heart with "NEVER YOUR FAULT" in big letters, with Hackle hugging it.

Field note

No. 3

For families (printed at the bottom of this page): Ask your child, "Who is on your Tell-Someone Team?" Tell them: "You can tell me anything, and you will never be in trouble."

2

LESSON 10: SCREEN BALANCE

Page 1: How do I feel?

2

Picture 45



ART TO COME

Six round feelings faces in a row: happy, calm, excited, tired, worried, mad/sad. Each with a one-word label.

Draw a line from Lily to the face that shows how she feels after a very long time on the tablet. (match icon)

Picture 46



ART TO COME

Lily sitting with a tablet on the left, with a long squiggly line to the faces on the right.

Page 2: My Balance Plate (pencil icon)

Picture 47



ART TO COME

A big plate divided into four wedges. Wedge 1: a running child icon labeled "Move." Wedge 2: two hands joined labeled "People." Wedge 3: a book and crayon labeled "Quiet." Wedge 4: a tablet labeled "Screen."

Draw something you like in each wedge. **Screens are one wedge, not the whole plate!**

Page 3: My break menu (circle icon)

2

Picture 48

ART TO COME

Eight round pictures, each with a one-word label: Play outside, Draw, Read, Sing, Cook, Stretch, Pet or toy, Talk to a grown-up.

Circle **three** breaks you would pick.

If a screen ever makes me sad, mad, or worried, I:

Picture 49

ART TO COME

A child with hand-on-heart reaching toward a smiling grown-up. Label: "TELL."

Color the word **TELL.** (crayon icon)

MY HACKLES CERTIFICATE

2

Picture 50



ART TO COME

A full-page certificate with a colorful border. A rosette ribbon. Hackle in a graduation cap in the top-left corner and the four friends cheering in the bottom corners. A banner says "HACKLES CHAMP."

Chapter HACKLES CHAMP

3

3

This certificate says that

knows how to

NOTICE HACKLES UP. PAUSE. CHECK. TELL.

Picture 51



ART TO COME

Four small hand-signal icons: a hand brushing up the neck, a palm, eyes, and a hand on heart reaching out.

I know a **false alarm is fine.**

I know my **Tell-Someone Team.**

I know **passwords are private.**

I know **it is never my fault.**

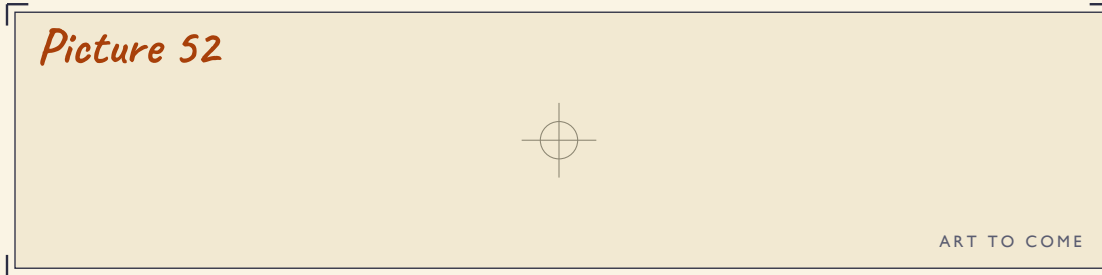
I know I can **keep telling until someone helps.**

Teacher's signature: -----

Date: -----

MY TELL-SOMEONE TEAM (Pocket Card)

Cut on the dotted line. Fold on the middle line. It fits in a pocket or a backpack.



A rectangle with a dotted cut line. Fold line down the middle. Left side (front): a big hand outline with five finger circles labeled "My Tell-Someone Team." Hackle in the corner. Right side (back): four icons: a hand brushing up the neck ("Hackles up?"), a palm ("Pause"), eyes ("Check"), heart-reach ("Tell"), and a speech bubble: "I need help."

Front (inside left):

My Tell-Someone Team

1. _____ (home)
2. _____ (school)
3. _____ (school)
4. _____ (extra)
5. _____ (extra)

Back (inside right):

- I need help.
- It is never my fault.
- I will never be in trouble for telling.
- Keep telling until someone helps.

Outside back: HACKLES UP? PAUSE · CHECK · TELL

Picture 53

ART TO COME

3

*Hackle waving, the four hand signals, and a small heart.**Field note*

No. 4

Teacher note: Children may need help writing names. Offer pictures or initials. For children who have no home helper, name school helpers. Print on card stock if possible, and laminate if budget allows.